The Socratic Metric (SM) Student Guidelines

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Introduction

Welcome to the Socratic Metric (SM) Students' Assignment Guidelines. Think of this handout as your roadmap to feeling confident and ready for your SM interactions. The Socratic Metric is not a traditional exam, it's a conversation-style assessment that allows you to show what you've learned in your own words.

In the following pages, you'll find everything you need: how to set up your space, what to expect during the session, and helpful tips to make the process easier. You'll also see examples of how you might respond so you know exactly what this looks like in practice.

Most importantly, remember that the SM is here to support your learning, not to trick you. It's your chance to reflect, explain, and connect course concepts using your voice. Whether English is your first language or not, you'll be guided step by step. Focus on sharing your understanding, not on perfect grammar or polished speeches.

Read through this handout carefully, take your time, and approach your session as if you were having a thoughtful conversation with a friend. You've got this!

What is the Socratic Metric (SM)

The Socratic Metric (SM) is an oral assessment tool that measures your understanding of course concepts through spoken responses. Unlike a written test, the SM focuses on evaluating authenticity, comprehension, and verbal reasoning. The material assessed comes directly from the course content outlined in your syllabus every week.

General Expectations

- You may use any and all course materials to assist you during the session.
- This is 100% oral: all questions must be read aloud and answered aloud.
- No two sessions are alike. Questions are randomized and personalized.
- Speak slowly and clearly so your responses are easy to understand.

Student Registration

First, watch this tutorial first: How_to_create_account.mp4

Students:

- Must only use their WU email credentials.
- Should sign up using the Student Portal https://westcliff-soc-student.vercel.app
- Must do the following:
    - Retain their confirmation email.
    - Present the confirmation email if login issues occur.
    - Avoid trying to sign in before completing the sign up process as this causes login errors.

First Sign In

- After receiving the confirmation email students should sign in using the Student Portal

Watch out! When setting up a Socratic Metric (SM) account, the confirmation email often goes to the Spam or Junk folder. It's important to check these folders if the confirmation email does not appear in the inbox right away. To avoid missing important messages in the future, users should mark the email as "Not Spam" or move it into their inbox. If the confirmation email still doesn't arrive after a few minutes, the next step is to resend the confirmation or reach out to SM Support at **ssm-support@mitras.ai** for assistance.

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Environment & Setup

First watch the following two tutorials

a. Getting Started: How to begin an assignment
b. Assignment Completion: How to complete an assignment

1. **Prepare Your Space**
    - Test your microphone ahead of time to ensure it is working properly.
    - Find a quiet, distraction-free space where you can speak comfortably.
    - Use a device with a clear microphone and ensure a stable internet connection.

2. **Check Your Equipment**
    - Confirm the correct input device is selected in your microphone settings.
    - Test your audio to make sure your voice is being picked up clearly.

3. **If SM Repeats Your Words or Has Trouble Understanding What It Is Hearing**
    - Adjust your microphone settings.
    - Try a different headset, computer, or mobile device such as a cell phone, as many have superior microphones and noise-canceling features.
    - Reduce background or white noise, even if it is not noticeable to you. Again, speak clearly and slightly slower, especially if you have a strong accent

4. **Record Your SM Activities Socratic Metric (SM)**

Activities are not automatically saved in your courseroom. To make sure your participation is counted:

- Log your SM activity in the courseroom right after you finish your work in SM.

- Check that your activity shows up in the courseroom to confirm it is recorded.
- Return to GAP and reply to the professor's discussion topic to indicate the assignment is "completed."
- If you used AI you must disclose it. For example, say "I have completed the assignment and I used AI to organize my ideas and notes."
- If no activity is recorded in the courseroom for 14 days, you could be at risk of administrative withdrawal.

> 📌 **Keep in Mind**
> Taking a minute to log your activity each time will help you stay active, avoid problems, and get full credit for your work!

AI Use in SM

AI tools can be valuable for preparing, practicing, and even supporting you during your SM session, but they must never replace your own authentic voice and reasoning. To stay within Westcliff's academic integrity policies, please follow these guidelines:

Proper Use of AI (Preparation and During Your SM Session):

- You may use AI to brainstorm possible study questions or practice ideas.
- You may ask AI to explain complex course concepts or summarize textbook material for your review.
- You may use AI for grammar suggestions or to help organize your study notes.
- While responding in SM, you may draw upon ideas you developed with AI, but you must paraphrase, explain, and express ideas in your own words.
- If you use AI in these ways, remember to take responsibility for accuracy and understanding, and be ready to explain concepts authentically.

Improper Use of AI:

- Do not recite AI-generated answers word-for-word. A mindless recitation does not demonstrate learning.
- Do not use a computer, phone, or other device to read responses aloud on your behalf.
- Do not have AI generate spoken responses for you. Your authentic voice and reasoning must be what SM measures.

Why This Matters: The Socratic Metric is designed to evaluate *your* understanding, in *your* words and voice. AI can be a helpful preparation and support tool, and you may even use it to develop ideas for your responses. However, when you speak your answers, you are expected to **reflect, paraphrase and explain in your own way**. Simply reciting AI text or letting a device speak for you does not demonstrate your learning and is not permitted.

Reading Questions Aloud

- You must read each question aloud and correctly record at least 70% of the written content before answering.
- A prompt indicator below the question will show that you did not reach the 70% threshold, but if you achieved 70% or greater the button will indicate read.
- Speak naturally and at a comfortable pace so SM can capture your words accurately.
- Pronunciation perfection is not required. Focus on delivering your answer clearly enough for the system to understand.
- If you receive pronunciation feedback from SM and want to improve, read this handout with tips to improve.

Answering the Questions

- Speak as if you are explaining your answer to a friend.

- Authenticity is key. The system values genuine, thoughtful responses more than polished delivery.
- You may jot down notes before speaking but do not read from a prepared script or AI-generated response.
- Listen carefully to each question and take a moment to gather your thoughts before responding.
- Questions may be hypothetical or applied, requiring you to demonstrate conceptual understanding.

📌 **Keep in Mind**

When you answer questions in the Socratic Metric, just speak in your normal voice, as if you were talking to a friend. You will have your textbook and any other course materials in front of you, and you are welcome to use them at any time. Please avoid reading directly from the book or other materials. You are welcome to paraphrase or refer to specific pages if you like, though this is completely optional.

Remember, the Socratic Metric is not about writing perfectly crafted essays. Instead, it focuses on how well you understand, recall, and explain the course concepts in your own words. For example, you might say, *"I see on page 3 of the textbook, the author says that…"* or *"I found another article that says…"*

Iterations & Feedback

- After each answer, SM will give you an immediate assessment and feedback.
- You may add your answer up to four more times using the system's suggestions.
- Before refining your response or continuing to the next question, you must read aloud the system's assessment and improvement suggestions.
- You must correctly record at least 70% of this feedback to proceed.

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Integrity & Detection

- Do not use any device, such as a computer, to read or speak for you.
- Do not allow another person to read or speak for you.
- SM tracks voice patterns and delivery to detect authenticity.
- Attempts to read scripted or AI-generated answers will be flagged.
- There is no advantage to cheating. Just do your best and learn from the process.

Submission Instructions

- After completing the fifth question and any iterations, click the Finish Assessment button.
- Read the message **Please do not leave this page!** We are currently processing your assignment. **Leaving this page now may result in an incomplete submission!**
- Wait until you see the page that says Assignment Complete!

Your Privacy and Voice Data

Your privacy matters. Here's how your voice data is protected when you use our AI-supported learning tools:

- **Safe and Secure:** Your recordings stay in our secure system and are never shared or used to train outside AI models.
- **Private Access:** Only your professors and authorized faculty involved in your learning can access your recordings.
- **Temporary Storage:** Your voice data is kept only as long as needed for grading and accreditation, then deleted or anonymized.
- **Fair and Unbiased:** SM doesn't grade you based on your accent, tone, or style. Your professors handle grading using clear rubrics.

- **Transparency:** You'll always know how your data is used, there are no hidden purposes or secret uses.

To recap, you can watch: Full platform walkthrough

In short, your voice and personal data are treated with the same seriousness as your academic records.

Final Thoughts

The Socratic Metric is designed to help you learn, not to trick you. It gives you the chance to share what you know in your own words, whether English is your first language or not. What matters most is not perfect grammar or pronunciation, but clear articulation, authentic thought, personal reflection, and genuine learning. This is your opportunity to demonstrate real understanding and connect your voice to the ideas you've studied!

Technical Support

- SM Support Email: Always contact your instructor first! If you need extra support, your professor will email @socraticmetricmentors@westcliff.edu
    - Always include:
        - Your full name
        - Your Westcliff email address
        - A detailed description of the problem
        - Screen captures if relevant

